

Charles Erker

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EDUCATION

University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS

Expected May 2028

B.S. Mechanical Engineering | Minor in Business

GPA: 3.88/4.0 | KU Honors Program

EXPERIENCE

Siemens Digital Industries Software, St. Louis, MO

May 2026 – Present

Business Operations & Commercial Enablement Intern — Aerospace, Defense & Transportation

- Partner directly with the VP of Strategy Execution & Operations to identify and resolve operational gaps across sales, client engagement, and delivery within the Aerospace, Defense & Transportation division
- Diagnosed the root cause of recurring miscommunication between sales and delivery teams and designed a structured client handoff framework now adopted across the team
- Drove cross-functional alignment by organizing and leading department-wide meetings, synthesizing emerging technology trends into clear, actionable updates for leadership
- Reframed complex technical products into simple, client-ready narratives, sharpening the sales team's story for aerospace and defense buyers

Champion Sportswear, Lawrence, KS

Aug 2025 – May 2026

Marketing Intern

- Analyzed consumer trends and purchase behavior to inform product strategy; presented findings and recommendations to cross-functional partners in design, marketing, and brand management

CIC Group, St. Louis, MO

Jun – Jul 2025

Corporate Intern (Nooter Construction, Nooter Eriksen Engineers, and Wyatt)

- Rotated across three business units to build a working knowledge of how each operates, from construction management and field engineering to estimating and preconstruction
- Partnered with estimators in the Chicago and Philadelphia offices and spent time on active job sites with rigging engineers and drafters to see project execution end to end
- Assessed how QA/QC standards were applied across three concurrent projects, surfacing how operational consistency is maintained at scale

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

KU Consulting Scholars Program, Lawrence, KS

Jun 2026 – Present

Co-Founder & Associate

- Co-founded and structured KU's first consulting prep program from scratch, building the curriculum, recruiting the founding cohort, and establishing practitioner partnerships

Kirkendall Ideation Challenge, Lawrence, KS

Sep – Nov 2025

1st Place — Entrepreneurship Competition

- Led end-to-end development of an AI-integrated K-12 education platform, from ideation and stakeholder interviews to prototyping and go-to-market strategy; placed first in 2025 and returned as a peer mentor for 2026

KU Case Competition Club, Lawrence, KS

Oct 2024 – Present

VP of Consulting Relations

- Manage relationships with consulting firms to grow KU's network, overseeing both the on-campus competition and the Best in the Midwest National Case Competition, an invitational event the club plans, hosts, and funds independently

KU National Case Competition Team

Oct 2024 – Present

- 1st Place — Best in the Midwest National Case Competition
- 1st Place — UMSL International Business Case Competition
- 3rd Place — Wisconsin Invitational Consulting Case Competition (co-sponsored by McKinsey, Accenture & Deloitte)

SELF Engineering Leadership Fellows, Lawrence, KS

Aug 2024 – Present

Cohort Co-Lead (Class of 2028)

- Led four community-focused engineering projects (\$1,500 budgets each), owning nonprofit outreach, project scoping, and team execution end to end

SKILLS

Software: Salesforce, SolidWorks, ZoomInfo, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, C++, MATLAB, MathCAD
